



TIPS & TRICKS

Mounting the removable devices automatically at a specified folder

This trick is for those who deal with many removable devices, with every device changing its name after you restart your system.

The solution is to mount devices by using their UUID (Universally Unique Identifier).

Run the following command:

```
# blkid
```

...which will show the UUID of devices. Now make an entry in the `/etc/fstab` file as shown below:

```
UUID=41c223418-fbad-4da6-8196-c816df0b7cc8 /rt ext3
defaults,errors=remount-ro 0 1
```

...and then save and exit the file. Make sure you back up the original `fstab` file to avoid any problems.

Now, type:

```
#mount -a
```

This will re-read the `fstab` entries.

This tip can also be applied in case of SAN storage, where every Logical Unit Number (LUN) needs to be mounted.

—Rohit Verma,
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Finding multiple file types with a single *find* command

You can *find* all the 'c' files or 'cpp' files in a directory using the *find* command, as follows:

```
#find dirname -iname '*.cpp'
```

This will return all the 'cpp' files in the directory 'dirname'.

If you want to find all the 'cpp' or 'c' files in a directory using a single command, use:

```
#find dirname ( -iname '*.c' -o -iname '*.cpp' )
```

—Rajeev N Sambhu,
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How to change a user to a super user

By doing a simple modification in the `/etc/passwd` file you can enable a normal user to act as a super user. Let us see how this can be done. First of all, create a normal user account *sampleuser*.

Then edit the file as shown below:

```
vi /etc/passwd
```

```
sampleuser:x:1002:100::/home/sampleuser:/bin/bash
```

Change `uid=0` in the above line.

```
sampleuser:x:0:100::/home/sampleuser:/bin/bash
```

Save and exit the file. Now your *sampleuser* can act as a super user (root).

—Kannan M,
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Merge and split PDF files in Ubuntu

Often, there is a need for splitting or merging a PDF file. Let's look at how to do this in Ubuntu.

Let's use *pdftk* to play around with PDF files. Open the terminal and type the following command:

```
sudo apt-get install pdftk
```

After successfully installing *pdftk*, run the following command to merge PDF files:

```
pdftk 1.pdf 2.pdf 3.pdf cat output merged.pdf
```

To split PDF files, use the following command:

```
pdftk 1.pdf cat 1-5 output new.pdf
```